

The Skin of a Lie

So, why do some people allow themselves to believe these myths? Personally, I think it's just easier to make excuses. Some people need to imagine a villain working against them to excuse their own failings or lack of motivation. They can't (or won't) say, "It's my fault I'm not winning," so they parrot the same tired old phrases they might have heard from their parents. There's a problem with this fallback position, though. You'll never make any progress as long as you're making excuses.

Back when I played college football, I remember making a mistake on the field and letting an opposing player get past me. My coach, a wise man named Ernie Horning, asked me what happened, and I had all kinds of excuses for why it wasn't my fault. Coach Horning looked at me and said, "Son, an excuse is the skin of a lie wrapped with a reason." As I thought about what he meant, I realized he had given me one of the most important life lessons I'd ever received. An excuse is a lie dressed up as an explanation. It's a way to justify my own mistakes and failures by blaming someone or something else. That's the easy way out, and it comes at a price. Wonderful mentors like my mom, uncles, grandparents, and the late, great Coach Horning helped me realize that excuses will steal any chance I have at success. If you want to get past the myths and set yourself on the path toward millionaire status, you've got to have the courage and conviction to say, *I'm the reason I'm not winning yet, and I'm the reason I will win in the future*. With that shift in mind-set, you'll start to see all the wealth-building opportunities that you used to think only came to *other* people—only this time, they'll be coming to you.